

Candidate Questionnaire

Please limit each response to approximately 200 words.

Candidate Name: _____ **Teresa Glass** _____

1. Vision for Technology in Education

What role should technology play in K-12 education, and how should that role differ across elementary, middle, and high school grade levels?

I just completed 18 years of service to St. Paul Public Schools (12 as an Occupational Therapist and 6 as district-wide Assistive Technology Professional). There are many settings within iPads that make learning more accessible for students with disabilities (Blind or low vision, physically impaired, learning disabled in reading or writing, Developmental Cognitive Deficits, etc). I observed how students were able to access curriculum and reach their maximum academic potentials when specific accessibility settings were enabled to support their specific needs. As an occupational therapist, I know that young students learn best when they have the opportunity to move often, explore and learn by touching and manipulating learning tools, while interacting with peers. I believe that an early focus on engaging students in fine and gross motor activities is important. There is a lot of research to support the benefits of teaching handwriting and having students engage in handwriting tasks, however, if a student has a disability, it is likely that they will require access to an iPad so that they may show what they know. As students get older, technology can play an important role in accessing information for deeper learning.

2. Student Devices and Classroom Learning

What is your perspective on the use of district-issued 1:1 devices (iPads) in Saint Paul Public Schools? What changes, if any, would you like to see in current practices (e.g., eliminate 1:1 devices for some or all grade levels, establish formal limits on screen time, move from iPads to Chromebooks, etc.)?

This is a complex issue due to the issues I name in the first question. Since all students have individual learning needs, this issue requires the input from experienced educators from all areas of SPPS education (General Education, Multi-Language Learners, and Special Education), with representation of educators from Early Childhood, Elementary, Middle, High School & Transition. Research into best practices would be necessary before making any decisions.

3. Attention, Engagement, and Student Well-Being

How should the district balance the educational benefits of technology with concerns related to student attention, engagement in learning, social development, mental health, and overall well-being?

Again, research into best practices in this area is important before any SPPS mandate should happen.

4. Evidence and Learning Outcomes

What evidence or metrics would you want to see to determine whether classroom technology is improving student learning and educational outcomes and whether there is sufficient return on the district's investment?

This is a complex issue that requires input from SPPS educators and parents, as well as looking at information on best practices for 1:1 iPad use in an educational system.

5. Family and Community Engagement

What role should parents, families, students, and educators play in shaping district technology policies and practices?

All have an important perspective and role in shaping SPPS district technology policies and practices.

6. Accountability and Oversight

As a School Board member, how would you evaluate progress on technology-related goals and hold district leadership accountable for implementation, budget, and outcomes?

To evaluate the progress, I would need to have access to data taken for each of the objectives set. The objectives should be clear on who is responsible for plans for implementation, who is responsible for the budget and how outcomes will be measured. Also the plan should include how often the progress will be evaluated.

7. Artificial Intelligence

As artificial intelligence and other emerging technologies become increasingly available to students and educators, what principles should guide district decisions about their use? Do you support a moratorium on generative AI in Saint Paul Public Schools while the district undertakes a full review?

Working at SPPS in Assistive Technology, we had iPads to provide to children several years before the district adopted 1:1 iPads for students. They were provided to non-verbal students who required AAC (Augmentative & Alternative Communication) to be able to communicate with peers and show what they know. We also provided them to students with physical impairments or LD (learning disabled) who were unable to express their knowledge of topics via handwriting. Students with Blindness or vision loss also benefited from iPads in order to access curriculum and learning and demonstrate their knowledge. Within all of this, we have utilized AI apps. I know that AI can support students to reach their academic potentials. There is also AI that has supported special education teachers to reduce their heavy paperwork load. Apart from this, I would need to do more research before making any decisions for SPPS districtwide.

8. Looking Ahead

If elected, what would be your highest priority related to technology use in Saint Paul Public Schools during your first term?

My priority would be to bring together knowledgeable people IN SPPS to gather data, research and best practices in this area to be better informed before major decisions are made.

Thank you for your participation. Please return to intentionaltechnologysaintpaul@gmail.com by September 25, 2026.